week, at which I was assigned to present our findings and recommend that we cross the lines and keep on working.

Two or three days before the meeting at the fight stadium, I was making a movie on location out at the beach when I was called to a telephone at a nearby oil station. The caller wouldn't identify himself but said that if I made the speech, a squad of people would be waiting for me.

"Your face will never be in pictures again," the voice said.

I reported the call to the director of the picture when I got back on the set, and when we closed for the day and went back to the studio, I was met by officers of the Burbank police force who hung a gun and a shoulder holster under my arm that I wore for the next seven months. They also put a twenty-four-hour guard on my house.

I later found out the plan was to throw acid in my face, which would have indeed ended my career in pictures.

I made the report to our members on schedule and said the CSU strike was a phony. They voted 2,748 to 509 in favor of going through the picket lines.

The gates of the studios soon became a bloody battleground of daily clashes between the people who wanted to work and the strikers and outside agitators brought in to help them. A union of waterfront workers headquartered in San Francisco suspected of having Communist affiliations sent mass pickets to aid the CSU strikers. Homes and cars were bombed and many people were seriously injured on the picket lines; workers trying to drive into a studio would be surrounded by pickets who'd pull open their car door or roll down a window and yank the worker's arm until they broke it, then say, "Go on, go to work, see how much you get done today."

We began traveling to the studios in caravans and rented buses. At midnight actors who were scheduled to work the next day would get a telephone call telling them where to rendezvous with the bus in the morning. One day I arrived